



Stop the Scroll of Doom:

10 (no: 5) Game inspired UI Tricks in Power Apps.

UX · POWER APPS · GAME DESIGN



South Coast User Group

Sandra Kiel

Stop the Scroll of Doom: 10 Game
inspired UI Tricks in Power Apps

Luke Smith

Building an Office Legal AI Assistant
Plugin using Microsoft AI

David Buckley

Never Miss Anything Again: Proactive
Workload Management with Copilot Studio

Martin Neale

Moving Beyond Pilots to Value: The
AI Operating Model Blueprint



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Sandra Kiel

Stop the Scroll of D
10 (no: 5) Game ins
UI Tricks in Power A



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Why people return to Games?

The 5 main reasons players come back to games



Because it's
fun



Because they feel
progress



Because their
people are there



Because it helps
them switch off



Because it makes
them feel good
about themselves

And that matters.

No one has to force them.

No one has to remind them three times.

No one has to explain why it matters.

They come back because the experience gives them a reason to.

Momentum!

Momentum is the metric nobody talks about in Business

Low Momentum (typical App):

You open the app →
a huge form →
you scroll →
you look for the right section →
you're unsure →
"I'll do it later".

It doesn't happen later.



High Momentum (Game UI Thinking):

You open the game →
you see "Step 1/4" →
"You are here" →
"Next: Choose Level" →
a clear button →
after clicking: "Play 

You stay in because the next step is obvious.

Momentum = how easy it feels to stick with it and keep going.

**Business apps are often
designed for completion.
Games are designed for return.**

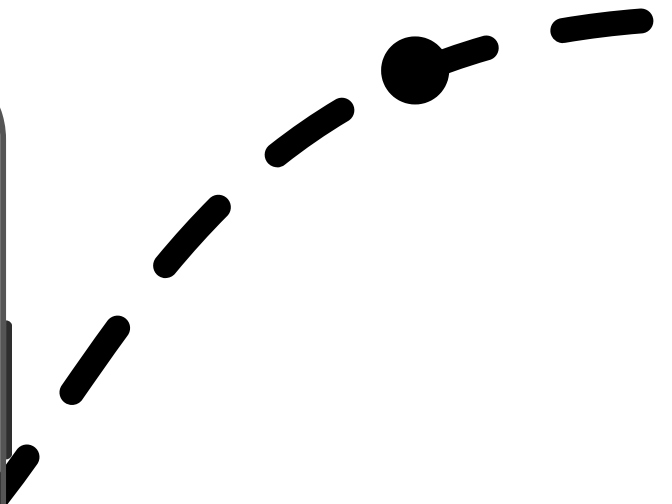


Levels of app experience

Functional

Motivating

Gamified





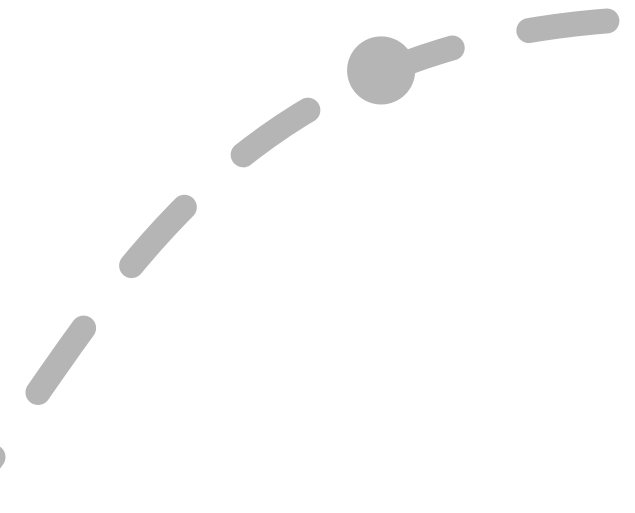
Levels of app experience

Functional



Motivating
(momentum-
friendly)

Gamified



The 5 Fixes for today that actually matter.



Each fix is small enough to actually ship. Together, they fundamentally change how a business app *feels*.

Stop the Scroll of Doom

Before: Endless Scroll

One giant screen
feels overwhelming
and directionless

Request Details

Requestor Information

First Name: Jane, Email: jane.smith@acme.com, Last Name: Smith, Department: Operations

Project Details

Project Name: Office Revamp, Project Code: OFF-2024, Priority: Medium, Start Date: 05/20/2024, Budget: \$50,000

Resource Requirements

Resource Type	Qty	Months
Team Member	UI Designer	1
Team Member	Dev Engineer	6
Team Member	Test Engineer	2

Budget Breakdown

Category	Amount
Labor Cost	\$16,000
Tools & Software	\$4,000
Licenses	\$2,000
Materials	\$5,000
Administrative Costs	\$2,000
Contingency	\$1,000
Total	\$30,000

Risk Assessment

List potential risks and how to mitigate them. Vendor delays; mitigate with early commitments.

Dependencies

List dependencies that may impact this project. Design system updates; vendor availability.

Stakeholders

List key stakeholders and their roles. Marketing, IT, Facilities.

Approval Chain

Approver Name	Role
Manager Name	Approval Chain
Director Name	Approval Chain
Finance	Approval Chain
Legal	Approval Chain
Executive Sponsor	Approval Chain

Save Cancel

Mission Overview

Step 2 of 4

Step 1 Basics (Completed)
Requestor and project details submitted.

Step 2 Details (Current)
Define resource needs and budget.
Continue

Step 3 Attachments (Locked)
Upload supporting documents.

Step 4 Review (Locked)
Final review and submission.

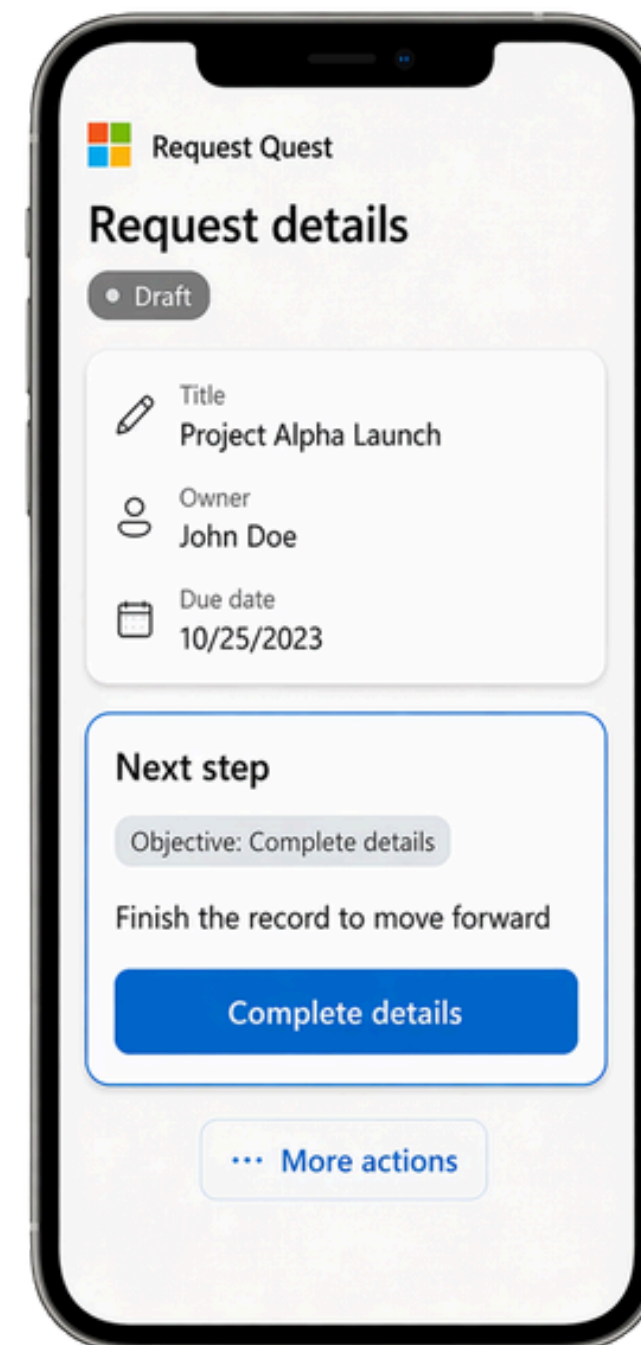
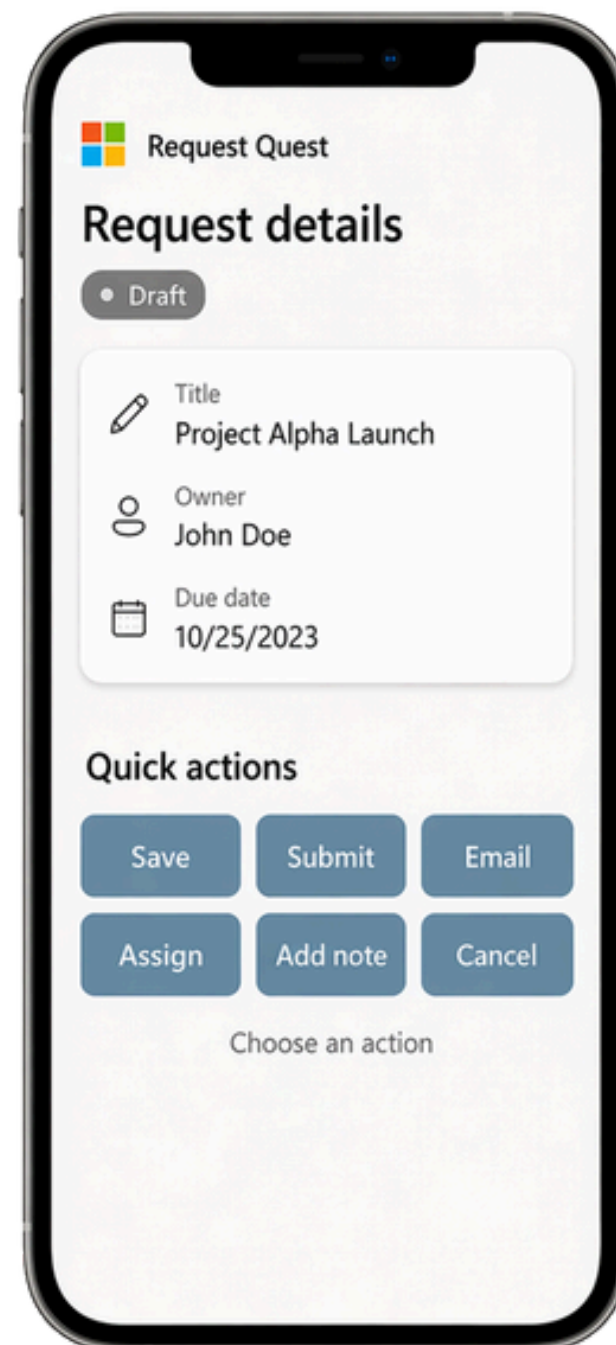
After: Chunked Steps

Clear steps with
progress and
completion
moments

Stop the Button Panic

Before: CTA Chaos

When everything looks equally important, every click feels risky.



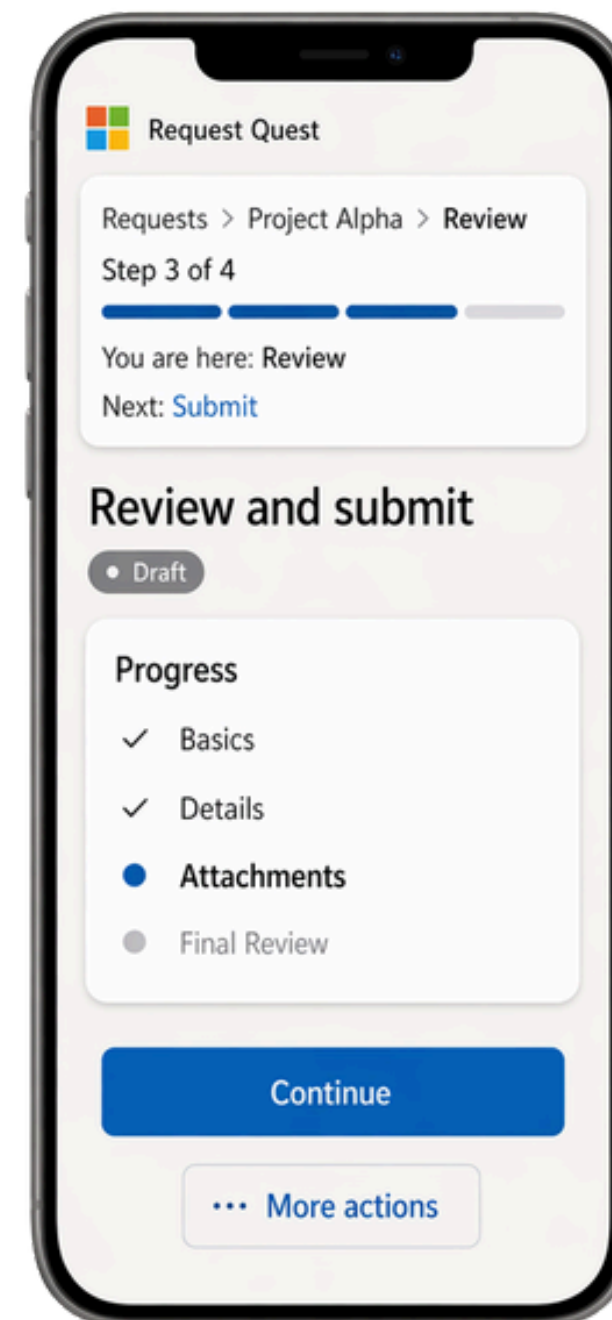
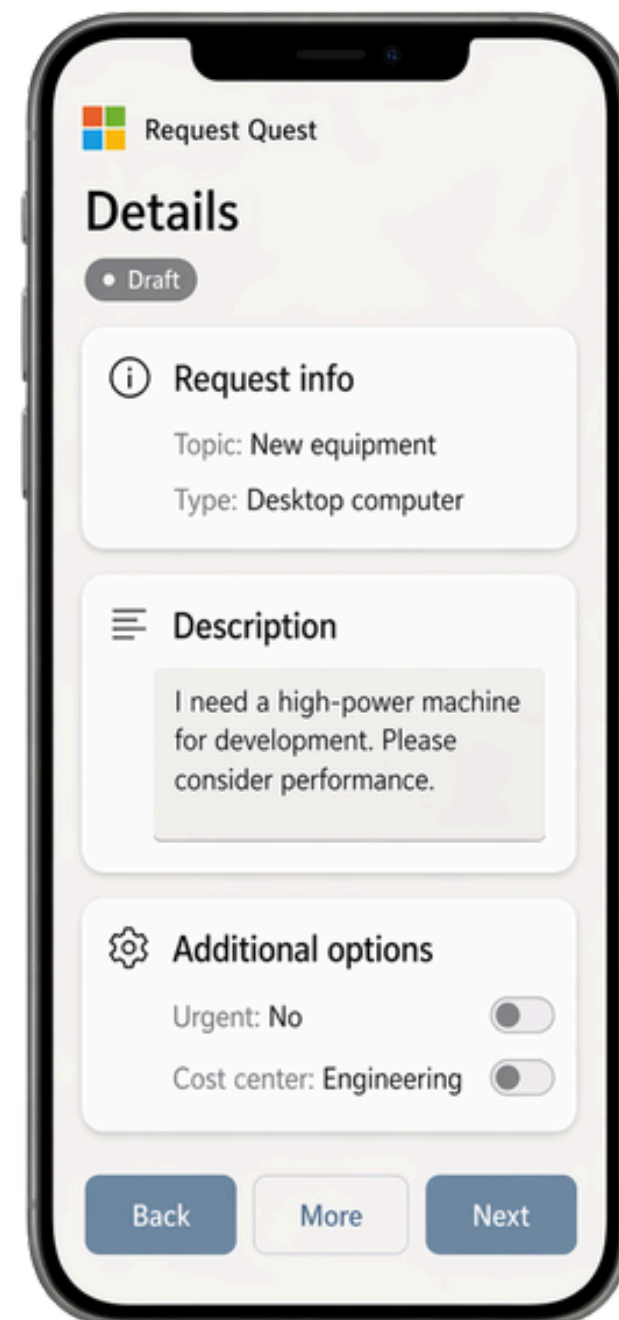
After: One clear next step

Primary action clearly highlighted. Secondary actions hidden under "More Actions".

Stop the **Lost Moment**

Before: Mystery navigation

No breadcrumbs, no progress, no orientation.
The pause moment arrives
– and users drop out.



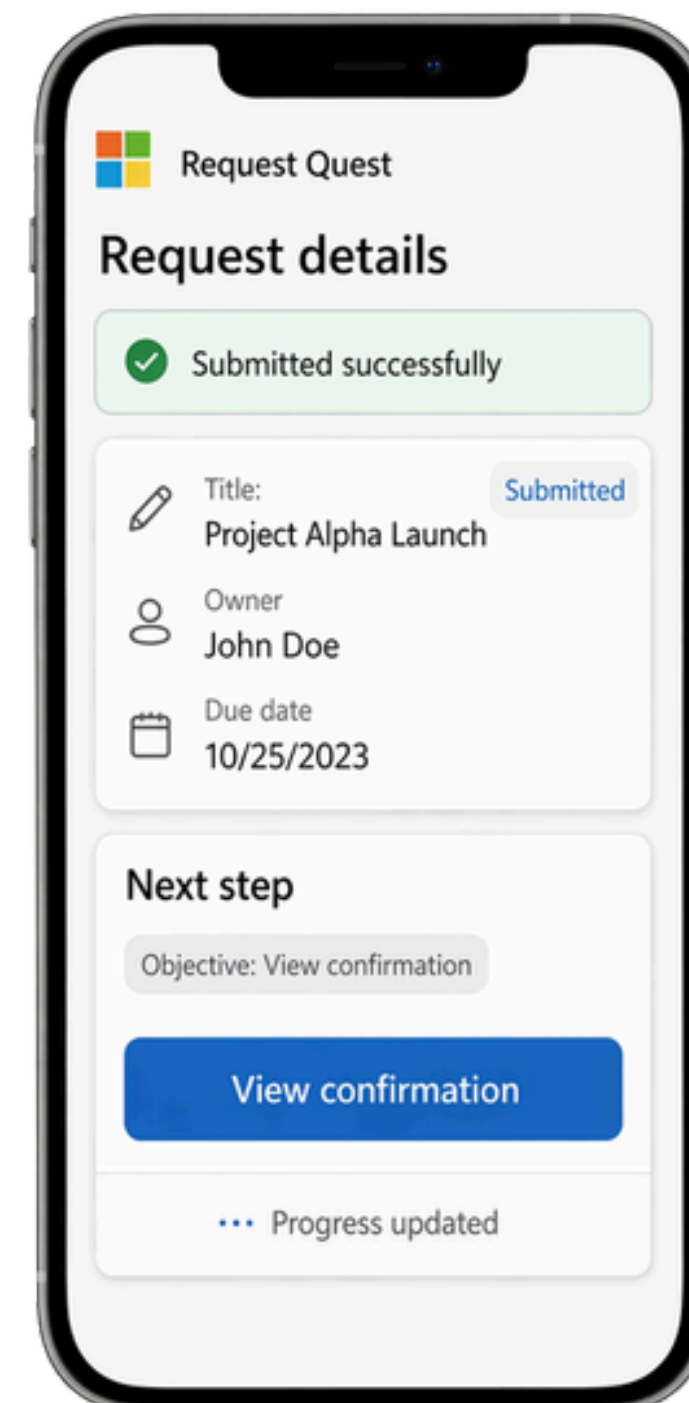
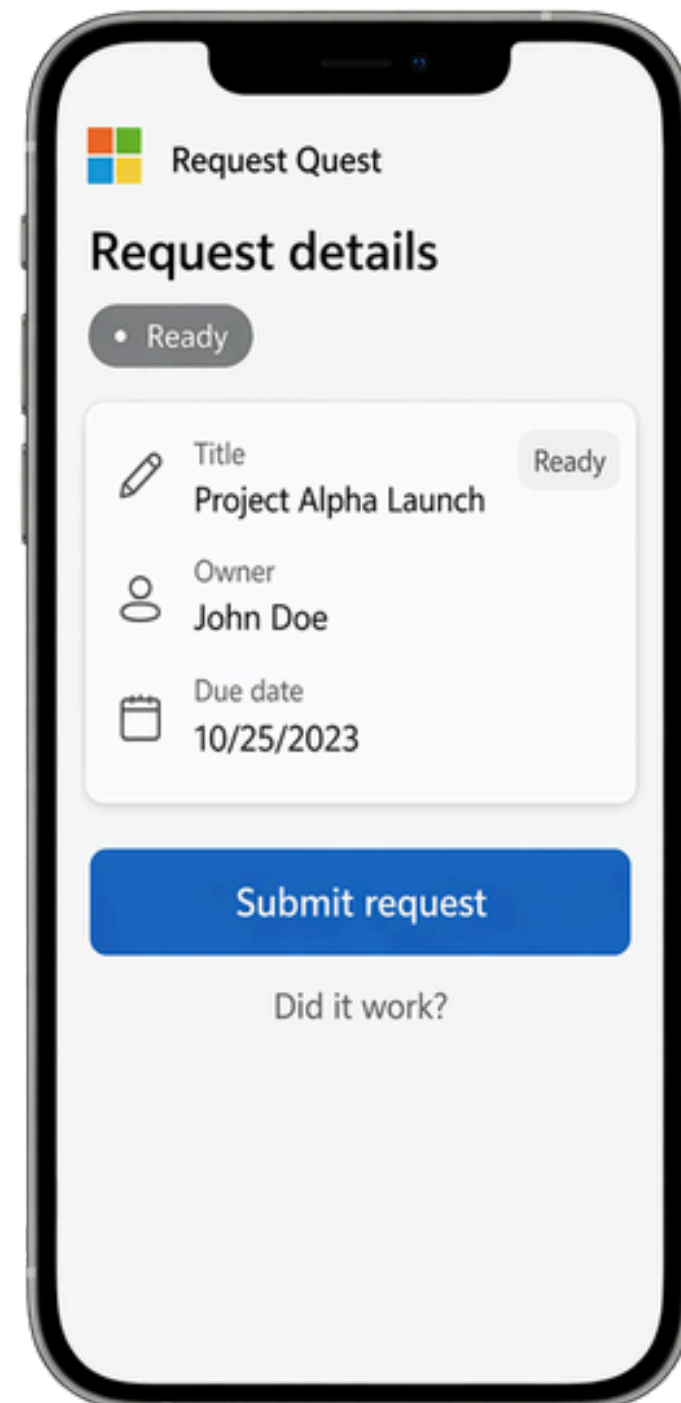
After: HUD Navigation

Orientation + Objective +
Progress at a glance.
Users always know where
they are and what comes
next.

Stop the **Silent Click**

Before: No Feedback

A user clicks. Then waits.
Then wonders. Then clicks
again. No visible loading.
No confirmation. No status
change. No trust.



After: Micro Feedback

A clear message with
context: What happened?
What should be done? No
generic "Error occurred".

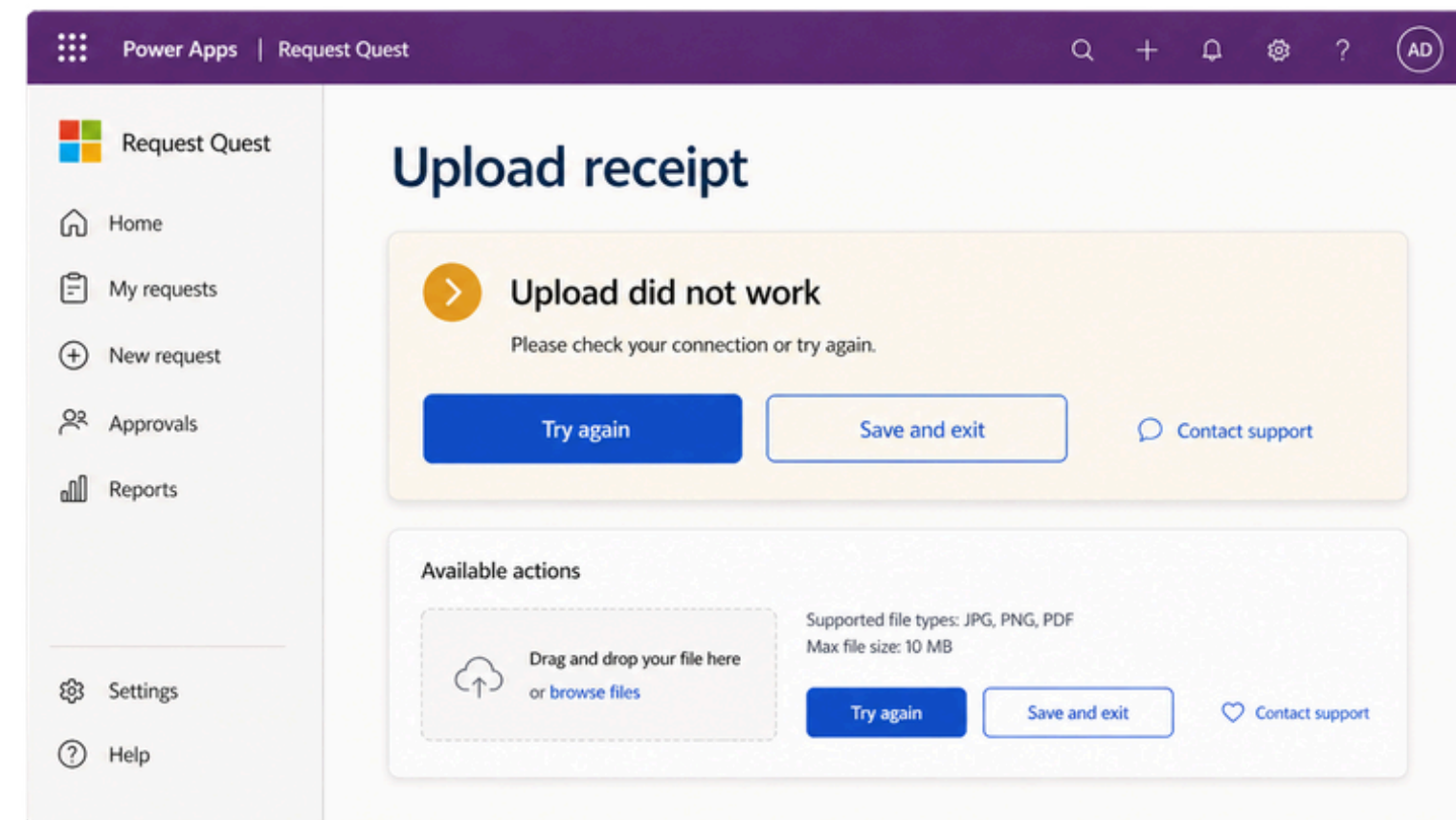
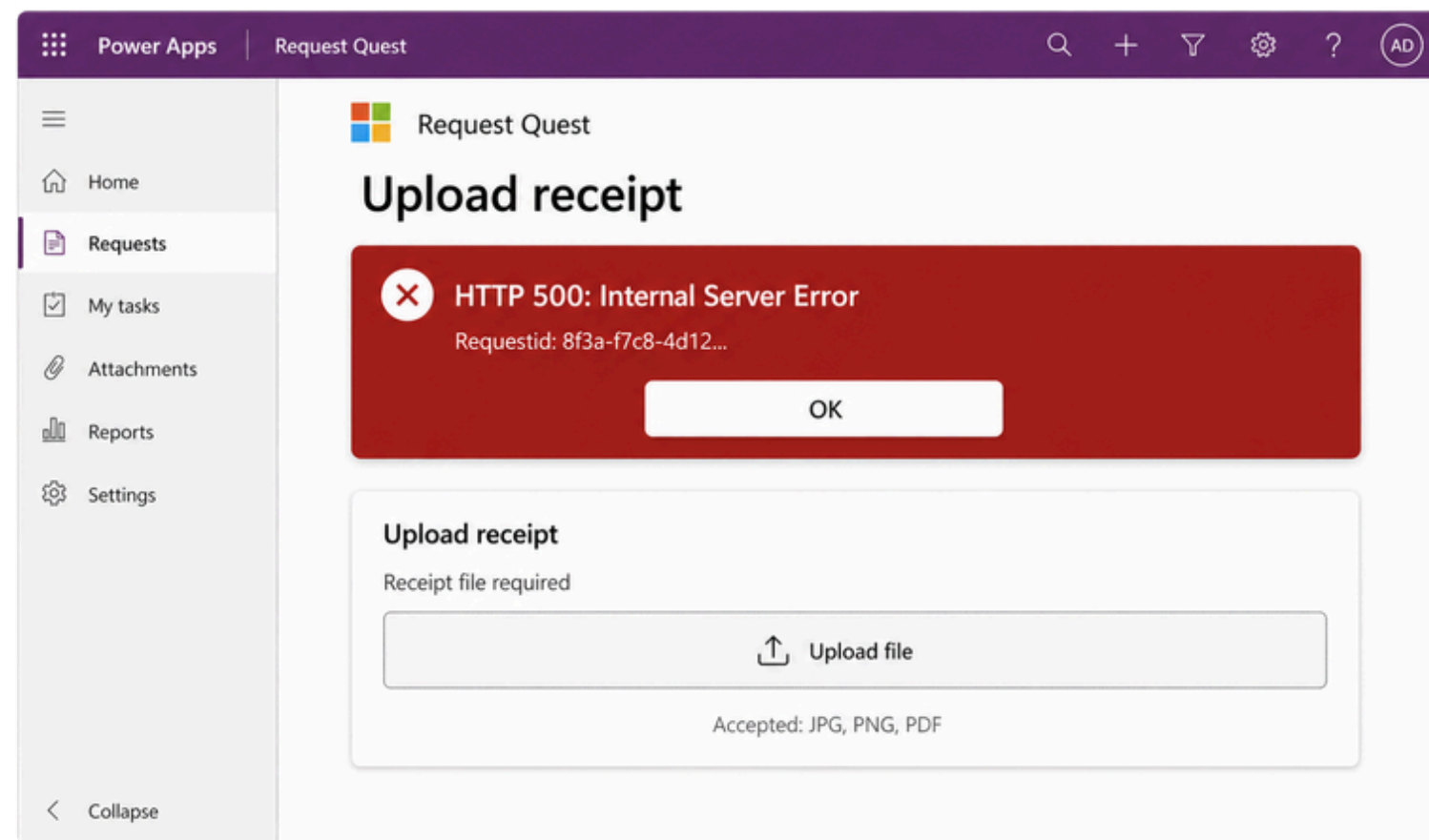
Stop the **Error Punishment**

Before: Punishment

Technical error message, no way out, no next step. Users feel guilty – and give up.

After: Recovery Path

Human language, clear action: "Please check field X." + "Try again" button. Mistakes should lead back into the flow, not cause embarrassment.



From **friction-heavy** to momentum-friendly

Friction-heavy UX feels

Flat	Overwhelming
Silent	Risky
Punishing	

Momentum-friendly UX feels

Guided	Structured
Reassuring	Responsive
Finishable	

The 30-minute patch plan

You don't need to rebuild everything. Patching is often enough. Take the one screen that generates the most questions – and apply these four fixes.

01

Identify the screen with the most questions

Ask support, check chats, observe. Where do users hesitate the longest?

02

Add: Next Step + HUD + Feedback States

A primary button. Breadcrumb and progress bar. Include loading and success status indicators.

03

Chunky in 3 steps when it scrolls

Break long forms down into missions. Step 1/3 is sufficient to start.

04

Test with an "Occasional User"

Don't ask the power users. Someone who rarely uses the app – that's your best feedback.

The first Level is not gamish.

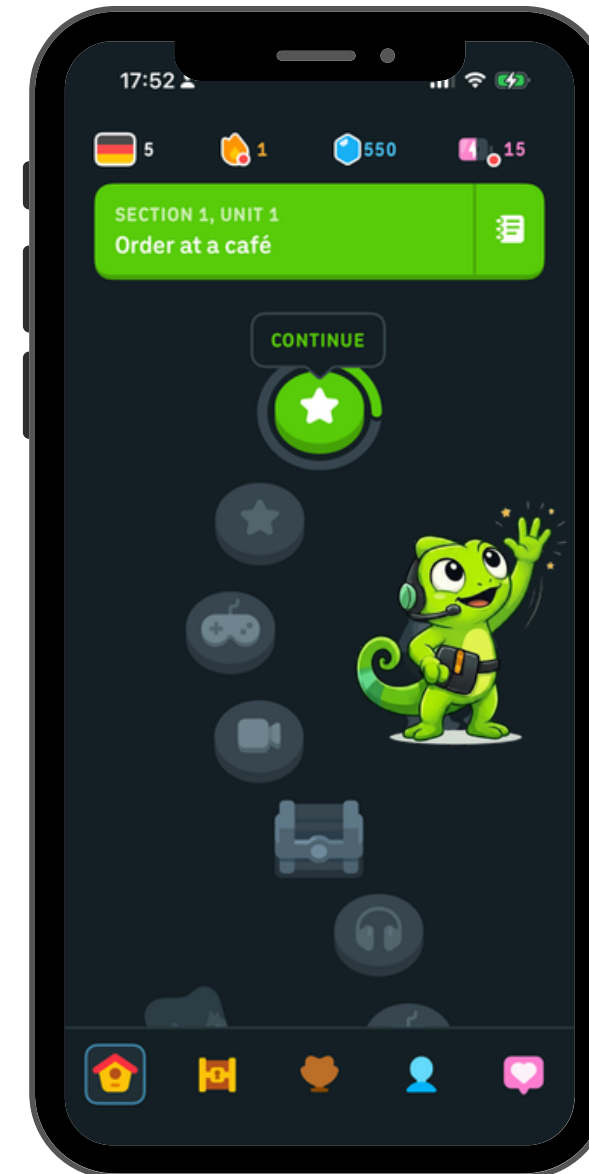
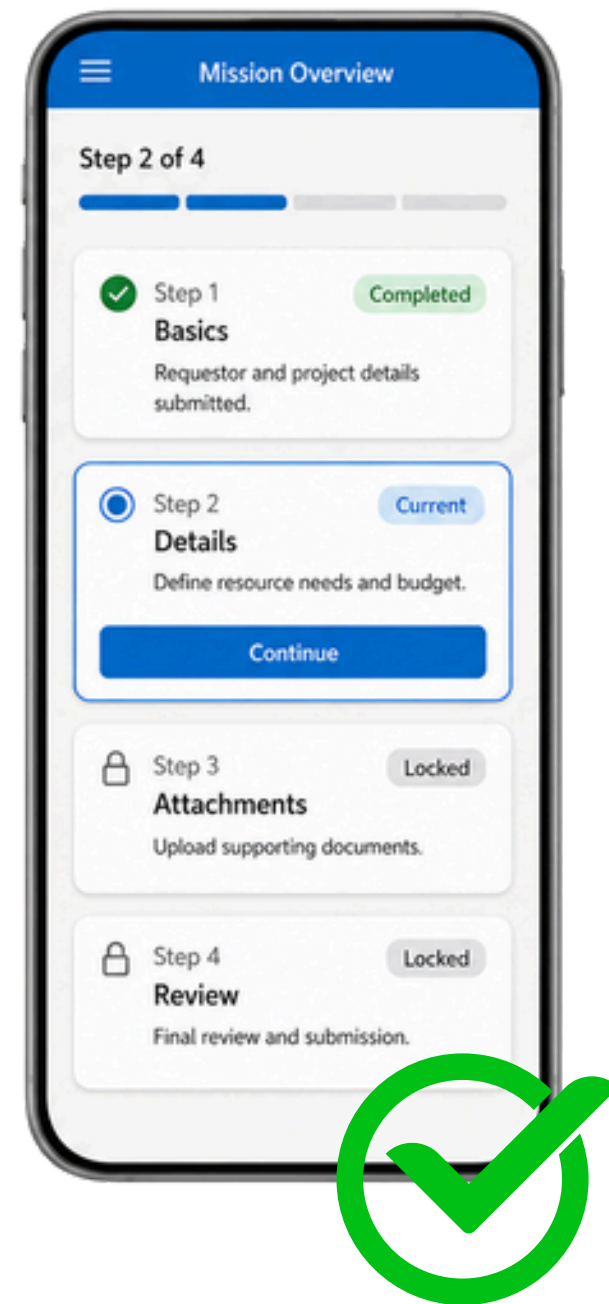
The first Level is clarity.

The Next Level: Momentum-friendly UX to Game UX

We optimized

- Progress
- Completion
- Action
- Orientation
- Feedback

The first Level is clarity.



...with Game UX we can add

- Purpose (hero)
- Rewards (badges)
- Challenges (streaks)
- Individualization (who/where I am)

These elements tap into intrinsic motivation and create sustainable habits.

Game UX adds

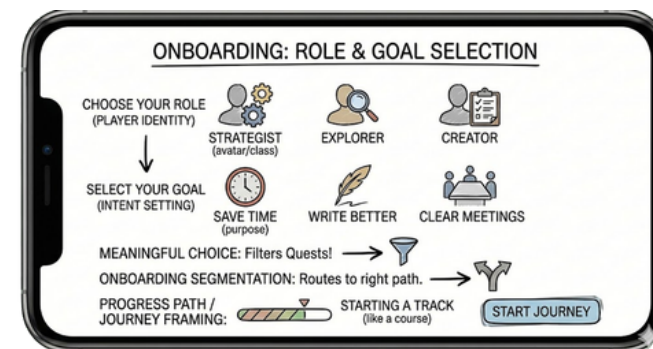
The Hero

A guide character makes the app feel approachable and gives clear next steps.



Individualization

Let users choose a role or goal so the journey feels personal.



Streaks

Creates a rhythm (daily habit)
Prevents "spam completing"
Makes return behavior predictable



Badges

Badges should not reward random clicks. They should reward meaningful progress.



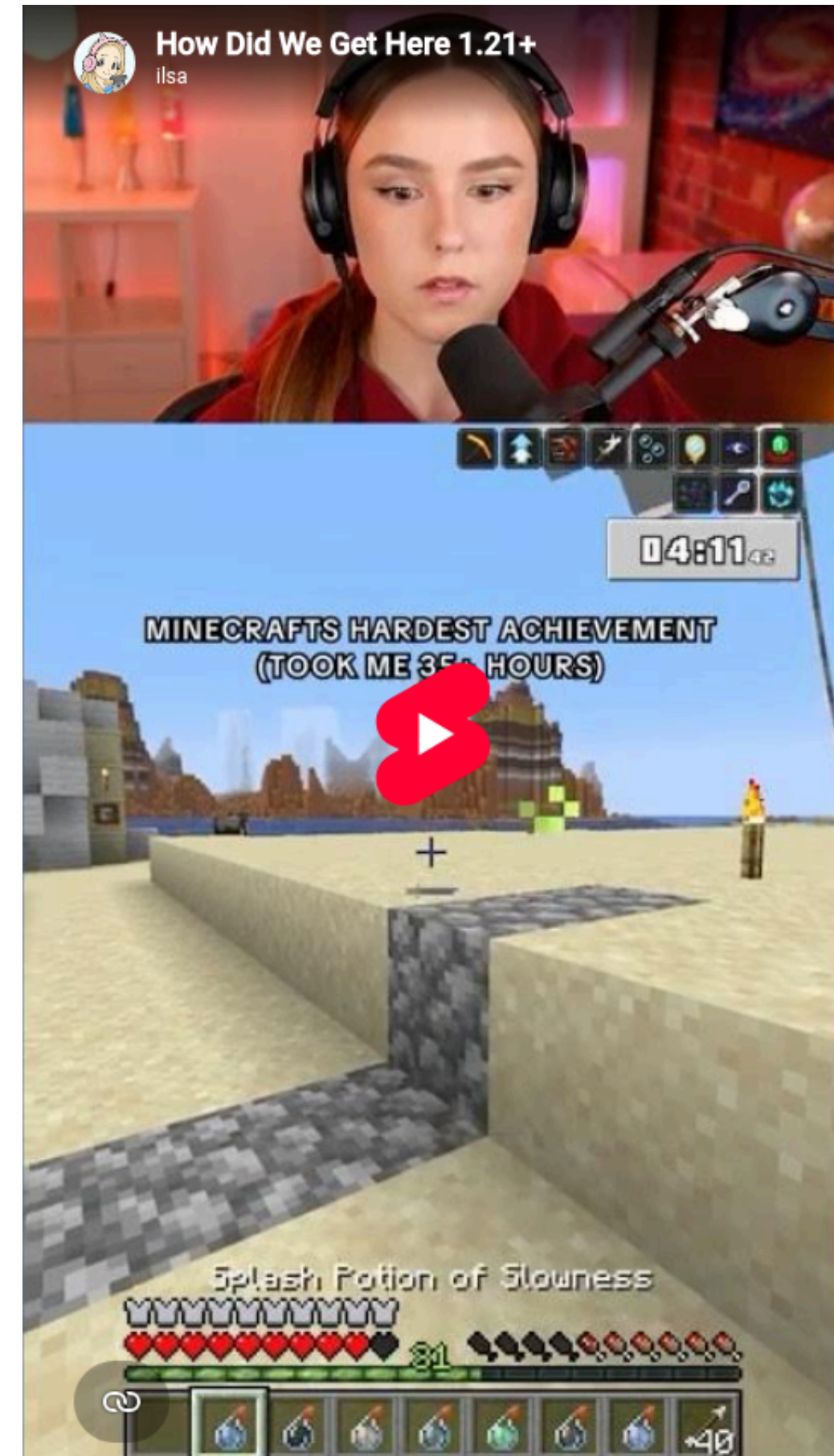
Demo Mode

What Minecraft's "How Did We Get Here?" teaches us about motivation

- It is difficult – you do not earn it by accident
- It feels meaningful – it proves effort, planning, and mastery
- It is memorable – even the name tells a story
- It is social – people want to share the moment

Badges should not reward random clicks.
They should reward meaningful progress.

Great badges create emotion, not just completion
A badge is not a sticker. It is a signal



Build for **more than completion.**

Build for **return.**

Thank you!

